

ARISAID Long *plaid* cloak worn by women in the Scottish Highlands and Islands, fastened by a brooch and a belt.

TRADITIONAL

ARMSCYE The armhole of a garment into which a sleeve is sewn.

ARMY SURPLUS Military clothing that was surplus to requirements and sold on to the public, such as *duffle coats* and *bomber jackets*.
1940s ▷

ART DECO An artistic style that emerged in Paris in the 1920s, the name deriving from the 1925 *Exposition Internationale des Arts Décoratifs*; it influenced many areas of art and design, including fashion, and featured streamlined shapes inspired by aerodynamic machines, and geometric designs such as the “sunburst”.

MID-1920s–LATE 1940s: SEE PP.253, 258–9

ARTISTIC DRESS Quasi-medieval style adopted by female followers of the Pre-Raphaelite artists; featured flowing, loose, high-waisted dresses.

1840s–c.1900: SEE P.214

ASTRAKHAN Lambskin from the Astrakhan region of Russia; also woven fabric resembling *lambskin*.

AUTOMOBILE COAT Also known as a motoring coat, a garment worn in early (open) cars to protect against wind and cold; made of leather or cloth with a thick lining; see also *Car coat*.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.230

AYLESHAM Wool or *linen* cloth made at Aylesham in Norfolk.

13TH–14TH CENTURY

B

BABY DOLL Style of nightwear comprising a short, sheer nightdress, often worn with short panties; inspired by the 1956 film *Baby Doll*.
1950s ▷

BABY DOLL DRESS A very short minidress, similar to the dresses a young girl might wear.

1960s ▷: SEE P.329

BACK BREADTH Tailoring term for the overall width of the two back pieces of a coat, at waist level.

BALACLAVA Woollen covering for the head and neck that leaves the face exposed; first worn by military personnel during the Crimean War.
1850s ▷

BALDRICK Belt worn across the body, from which a sword or drinking horn was hung.

13TH–17TH CENTURY: SEE PP.123, 129

BALLERINA SKIRT Full, ankle-length skirt with several layers of light fabric, inspired by classical ballet costumes; especially popular in the 1950s.

MID-20TH CENTURY ▷

BALLET PUMPS Shoes with a flat heel and a short *vamp*, resembling the slippers worn by ballet dancers.

1950s ▷: SEE P.340

BALLETS RUSSES Avant-garde dance company, led by Sergei Diaghilev; their striking, sensuous costumes, inspired by traditional Russian, Eastern, and Ancient Greek styles, still have a significant influence on fashion today.

EARLY 20TH CENTURY: SEE PP.244–5

BALL GOWN A long dress made from *silk* or other luxury material, short-sleeved or sleeveless, with a fitted, low-cut *bodice* and a full skirt.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.181, 198–9, 326–7

BAND A shirt collar; main types were the standing band (a flat, starched collar) and the falling band (a collar that was turned down); see also *Stand collar*, *Stand-fall collar*.

16TH–17TH CENTURY

BANDANA A handkerchief, typically with a white pattern on a red or blue ground, often folded diagonally and worn around the neck or head.

18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.434

BANDEAU Fabric headband first worn by women as decoration, but today commonly used in sports; also refers to a strapless *bikini* top.

EARLY 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.169, 180, 291

BANGLE A rigid band of jewellery, wide enough to be slipped over a hand or a foot.

LATE 18TH CENTURY ▷

BANYAN Originally a loose-skirted outdoor coat; the term was later used for a long housecoat for men, also known as an Indian gown, and made from *silk*, *linen*, or *cotton*.

c.1650–19TH CENTURY: SEE P.131

BASEBALL CAP Soft cloth cap with an eyeshade at the front, first used in baseball but now generally popular as an item of casual wear.

MID-19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.227

BASQUE Originally a long, close-fitting *bodice*; today a hip-length item of *lingerie* with *boning* and *brassière* cups; see also *Bustier*.



BASTING Joining fabric pieces temporarily with large running stitches before permanent stitching.

BATEAU NECK Also called a boat neck, a shallowly curved neckline extending almost to shoulder width.

1920s ▷: SEE PP.295, 335, 451

BATIK Javanese technique in which hot wax is applied to parts of a cloth in a pattern; the cloth is then dyed, the wax-coated areas resisting the dye to produce the design; sometimes known simply as “wax” in African countries.

SEE PP.457, 460

BATWING SLEEVE See *Dolman sleeve*.

BAUDEKIN An expensive decorated *silk*, some types having a warp of gold thread and a weft of *silk*.

MEDIEVAL

BEATNIK STYLE Style inspired by intellectuals in Paris and the Beat generation in San Francisco; featured black *polo necks*, *berets*, and for women, black *leotards* with black skirts and stockings and flat shoes.

LATE 1940s–1960s: SEE PP.380–1

BEAVER (a) Beaver fur, used for gloves; (b) a wool fabric with a raised *nap*, used for overcoats; (c) a *felt* including beaver fur, used for high-quality hats.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.128, 162–3

BELL-BOTTOMS Style of trousers fitting closely at the hips but with widely flaring lower legs, originally worn by sailors; see also *Flares*.

1960s: SEE PP.366–7, 372–3, 382–3

BELLOWS POCKET A type of *patch pocket* with sides that could expand; commonly used on *Norfolk jackets*.

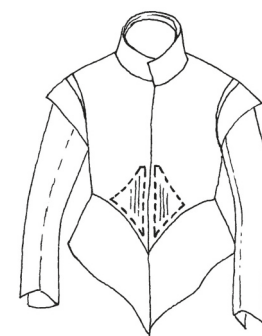
1890s ▷: SEE P.453

BELL SLEEVE In women's garments, a sleeve that fits closely from the shoulder to the mid-forearm and then flares widely to the wrist.

1850s ▷

BELLY-PIECES Shaped pieces of pasteboard, or *linen* reinforced with *whalebone*, sewn into the front of a *doublet* to support the abdomen.

c.1620–1670: SEE PP.118–19



BERET A soft, circular wool or *felt* cap, sometimes worn tilted to one side; originating in the Basque country, Spain, it is now worn worldwide.

20TH CENTURY ▷: SEE PP.396–7, 445

BERTHA COLLAR A wide, deep collar of *lace* or *silk*, fitted to a dress with a low *décolletage* and extending over the shoulders.

1840s–1920s: SEE P.142